

Question:

At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

The question requires knowledge of human brain development and anatomy . To answer this question , we need to consider the developmental stages of the human brain . At birth , the brain is still in its early stages of development , and different parts of the brain mature at different rates . The brain can be broadly divided into three main regions : the fore brain , mid brain , and hind brain . The fore brain includes the cerebral cortex , basal ganglia , thalamus , hypothalamus , and limbic system . The mid brain includes the tectum and tegmentum , and the hind brain includes the pons , medulla oblongata , and cerebellum .

The cerebral cortex , which is responsible for higher-order thinking , decision-making , and motor control , is still in its early stages of development at birth . The basal ganglia , which are involved in movement control and habit formation , are also still developing . The thalamus , which acts as a relay station for sensory and motor signals , is also still in its early stages of development . The hypothalamus , which regulates body temperature , hunger , thirst , and other basic bodily functions , is also still developing . The limbic system , which is involved in emotions , motivation , and memory , is also still in its early stages of development . The cerebellum , which is involved in balance and coordination , is also still developing . The brain stem , which controls basic functions such as breathing , heart rate , and blood pressure , is more developed than the other regions at birth .

Therefore , the least developed part of the brain at birth is the cerebral cortex , which is responsible for higher-order thinking , decision-making , and motor control . This is because the cerebral cortex continues to mature and develop throughout childhood and adolescence .

The correct answer is A . visual system